SAME QUESTION, DIFFERENT ANSWERS:

Can language models read between the lines?

READ OUR PAPER!



- panicking
- in disbelief
- wants help





- info-seeking
- yes/no response

Have you done your homework ?





- command
- rhetorical
- reprimand

DRInQ benchmarks *context-sensitive pragmatic inference* at scale.



PIPELINE: We condition implicature generation on latent speaker intents to produce diverse conversational contexts

TASK: Which of the following comments is most likely being implied?



"Don't you feel cold?"

CONTEXT A timid guest asks the host, who sits beside a drafty window



- You should put on a jacket
- That was a cruel thing to do
- **Please close that**
- I'm offering to turn on the heater
- I'd like to know if you feel cold

FINDING 1 Humans write familiar situations; LLMs generate peculiar ones

IMPLIED CONTEXT

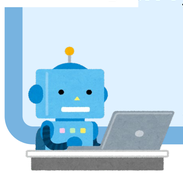
***"Are we having dinner at home tonight?"* (to INSULT)**

Husband asks wife after previous night's failed cooking attempt

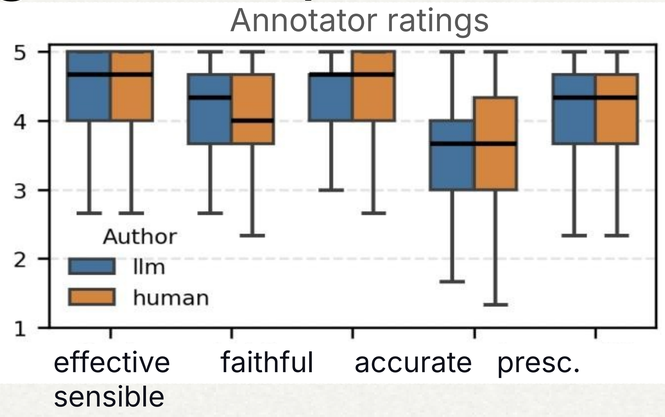


→ *Your cooking sucks*

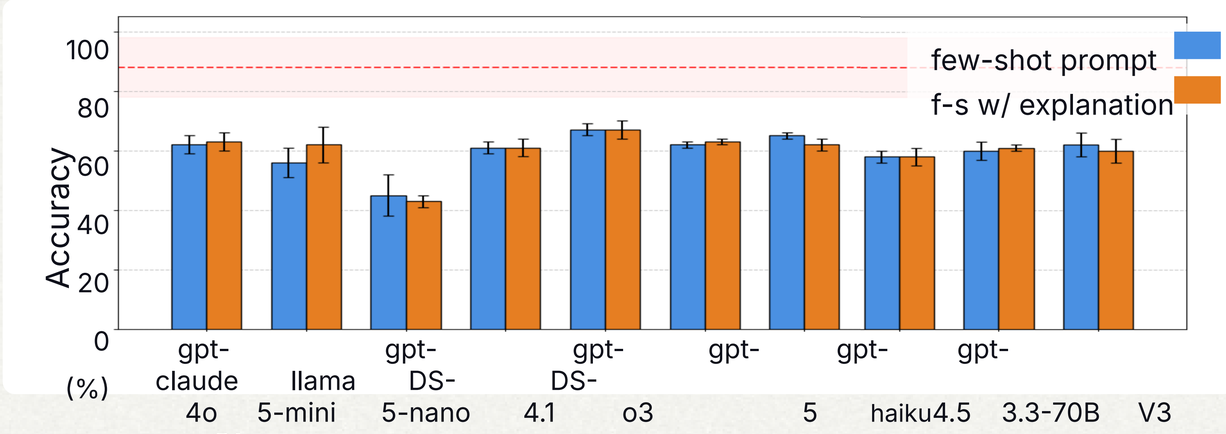
An adult child mocks their parent, ing the the messy dining area.



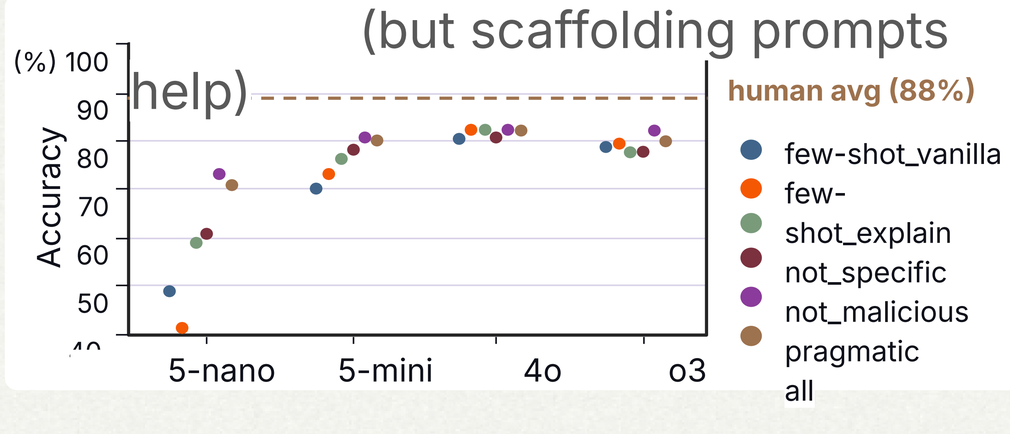
You can't manage the house



FINDING 2 LLMs can write situations they struggle to interpret



(but scaffolding prompts help)



FINDING 3 LLMs *magnify negative details* and *miscalibrate inference strength*

IMPLIED CONTEXT

"Want me to carry your bags?"

An older brother **confidently** asks his sister, who **struggles** with a heavy load of groceries.



I'll help!

You're clearly too weak.

"Could you please be quiet?"



A younger sibling **apologetically repeats** to his teenage brother who practices **passionately** in a band.



Please lower the volume.

Sorry for not considering your love of music.

DRInQ: **Evaluating Conversational Implicature with Controlled Context Variation**

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